

FURMAN ECONOMICS SOCIETY CONSTITUTION AND GOVERNING BYLAWS

Established Through the Furman Department of Economics
Created 2010

SECTION I

Name and Mission

ARTICLE I. Name. This organization shall officially be known as the Furman Economics Society, chartered at Furman University in Greenville, South Carolina.

ARTICLE II. Mission. The Mission of the Furman Economics Society is to build a stronger community within the Economics department, to strengthen the bonds between the faculty and staff, to expand the value of the Economics major beyond the classroom, and to enhance the relationship between the Economics department and the rest of the Furman Community.

ARTICLE III. Purpose. The Purpose for the Furman Economics Society is to provide a voice for the students in departmental decisions, to work with the Economics department to select guest lecturers and assist in the planning of their visits, to encourage participation in and advertise for Economics department events by working closely with the faculty, and to further encourage a sense of community through student and faculty lunches, picnics, and other social events.

SECTION II

Membership

ARTICLE I. Eligibility. All students of the Furman community are eligible to become a member of the Furman Economics Society. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

ARTICLE II. Membership. Membership for the Furman Economics Society is granted to any student that shows interest in this Society.

ARTICLE III. Good Standing. Members of the Furman Economics Society have the ability to be placed on the status of good standing if they meet certain criteria:

- a) Members must attend a minimum of two meetings for which they are enrolled and present at Furman University, or
- b) Members must actively participate in committee work as determined by the chairman of the committee, with approval of the Vice-President of Administration.

SECTION III

Meetings

ARTICLE I. Regular Meetings. Regular meetings shall be held at least once a month during the school year, preferably at a regular time and place.

ARTICLE II. Special Meetings. The President or faculty advisers shall reserve the right to call a special meeting with prior notice of no less than two (2) days being given to each member preceding a proposed special meeting, which shall be defined as any meeting that falls outside of the regular meeting schedule.

ARTICLE III. Meeting Structure. Meetings of the Furman Economics Society shall be conducted in accordance with the agenda prepared by the Executive Board.

SECTION IV

Voting

ARTICLE I. General Voting Procedure. Unless otherwise specified, voting shall be by a general vote, i.e. by upraised hand, and the outcome will be determined by simple majority of those present and in good standing. In the event of a tie, the President shall cast the deciding vote.

ARTICLE II. Secret Ballot. A secret ballot vote may be requested by any member for any vote. In all situations, this request will be honored.

SECTION V

Executive Board Offices and Duties

ARTICLE I. Executive Board Officers. The Furman Economics Society shall annually elect members to the Executive Board offices of President, Vice-President of Organization, Vice-President of Communications, Secretary, and Treasurer. In addition, a Faculty Advisor will be appointed by the Chair of the Economics Department in consultation with the Executive Board. Members may not hold more than one office. Multiple members may not jointly hold an office.

ARTICLE II. Nomination. At least one week prior to the scheduled election, the Furman Economics Society shall accept open nomination for all positions in the Society. Nominations must be made by a member on good standing. All nominees must be on good standing within the Society.

ARTICLE III. Election and Installation of Officers and Positions. Election shall be determined after free discussion from the floor of the members followed by a simple

majority vote of all members who are present. Each person shall serve a term of one (1) year or until their successor has been installed. There shall be no restrictions on the number of terms a member may serve in a particular office. Should a vacancy occur in any office throughout the year, it may be filled by a majority vote at any meeting.

ARTICLE IV. Term of Office. Each elected office shall be held per academic year, with elections occurring on the first Thursday in February for the following year's Executive Committee.

ARTICLE V. Duties of Officers:

President. The President shall preside at society meetings and shall guide the conduct of the affairs of the society. The President shall act as the voice of the society to the Economics department. In all voting situations, the President's vote shall be reserved to decide a tie. The President shall have the authority to delegate all duties not specified by the society Bylaws. They shall perform such other duties as the society may specify.

Vice-President of Administration. The Vice-President of Administration shall, in the absence or incapacity of the President, perform the duties of the President as well as circulate the agenda and keep the minutes of society meetings and an accurate list of members of the society, noting of those members on good standing. The Vice-President of Administration will be responsible for determining the validity of a member's good standing. The Vice-President of Administration will be responsible for the adherence to the Bylaws during all society meetings and events. They shall perform such other duties as the society may specify.

Vice-President of Communications. The Vice-President of Communications shall be responsible for publicizing department functions at least one (1) week in advance through various means of communication. The Vice-President of Communications shall perform such other duties as the society may specify.

Secretary. The Secretary shall be responsible for planning and implementing all social activities, including the Economics department Spring Picnic and other social functions designated by the society. The Secretary shall perform such other duties as the society may specify.

Treasurer. The Treasurer shall receive and disburse all society funds, and personally shall be responsible for all society funds coming into their possession; they shall, twice in each school year, submit to the society President a complete statement of the society finances, and shall at all times render such information about society finances as shall be requested by the President or the department staff. The Treasurer shall submit complete financial statements to the faculty advisor. They shall deposit, in an approved bank or with the appropriate school officer or organization, the funds of the society, and shall pay, or cause to be paid, by check all claims against the society upon the approval of the executive committee. The Treasurer shall perform such other duties as the society may specify.

Faculty Advisor. The faculty advisor shall act in an advisory capacity, and shall be liaison officer between the Furman Economics Society and the Furman Department of Economics. This society may elect more than one advisor.

SECTION VI

Committees

ARTICLE I. Appointment of Committees. All committees shall be appointed by the executive as circumstances require. Each committee will have a committee Chair appointed by the executive board.

SECTION VII

Finances

ARTICLE I. Budget. Before the last meeting of the academic year, a budget shall be passed for the following fiscal year, which extends from August through July. The budget must pass by an affirmative vote of three-fourths (3/4) of the members present. The budget must be presented at two successive meetings, and must be approved after the second reading. This budget must then be submitted to the Furman

ARTICLE II. Financial Policy. The Treasurer is given the power to authorize routine expenditures allowed in the budget. However, no officer, committee, or member of this society shall obligate the society financially without the consent of the society on any special expense. There shall be no expenditures without the approval of the society. Any unauthorized expenditure without proper consent is not guaranteed to be paid. Furthermore, any contract to be signed by any member therefore binding the society, financially or otherwise, must come before, be read, and approved by the society. Any debts incurred on the society by a single member are the responsibility of said member, not the society.

ARTICLE III. Reimbursements. No reimbursement shall be made for any society expenditures without an appropriate proof of purchases delivered to the Treasurer.

SECTION VIII

Rules of Order

ARTICLE I. Conducting Business. Business will be conducted during weekly meetings among the executive team, during which discussions about upcoming events will take place. Business can also take place through digital communication when more convenient.

ARTICLE II. Conflict Resolution. If conflict arises, it will be first handled among the executive team. All executive members will rationally discuss their points of view. If resolution is not reached, the matter will be brought to the faculty advisor.

SECTION IX

Amendments

ARTICLE I. Regulations for Amendments. These Furman Economic Society Bylaws may be amended at any business meeting by a two-thirds ($2/3$) vote of present members of the society. All amendments to the Policies shall be read two (2) times consecutively and voted upon after the second reading. All amendments must be submitted to the Student Government Association.

ARTICLE II. Review of Policies. These society policies shall be reviewed annually by the Furman Economics Society and when necessary revised.